

JUAN SEBASTIAN VASSALLO

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Curriculum Vitae

Field of artistic practice

Composer of instrumental and electronic music; Live electronics improviser; sound and multimedia artist; Pianist across diverse popular genres, including Argentine Tango and Jazz.

Education

2025 – Ph.D. in Artistic Research, University of Bergen (defended Sept. 2025).

2019 – Master’s degree in interdisciplinary studies (Music and Psychology), University of Victoria (Canada).

2013 – Bachelor’s degree in music composition (Licenciatura en Composición Musical), National University of Córdoba (Argentina). Five-year program integrating composition, theory, and music technology.

Pedagogical Training

2008 – University Professor’s diploma in music composition (Profesorado en Composición Musical), National University of Córdoba (Argentina). Pedagogical training in music composition and music theory at the university level.

2007 – Professor’s Diploma in Piano (Profesor de Piano) – Provincial Conservatory of Córdoba (Argentina). A seven-year professional and pedagogical program qualifying for music teaching at all educational levels.

Additional relevant training

2023 – Certificate in Data Sciences – Digital House Coding School. Buenos Aires, Argentina.

2021 – Certificate in Full-Stack Web Development– Digital House Coding School. Buenos Aires, Argentina.

2010 – Certificate in Cultural Management – Universidad Nacional de Córdoba, Argentina.

Research activities

2026 – Short-term joint research stay at Lübeck University, Lübeck Music High School and Ligeti Zentrum (Hamburg HfMT) funded by DAAD (German Academic Exchange Services). Project: “The Post-Generative Machine – Creative Approaches beyond Generative AI”. From April to June to carry out artistic research and technical developments in AI-based creative tools.

2020-2025 – Doctoral Artistic Research: “Outward Threads – Intuitive Computers / Rational Composers,” University of Bergen. Investigated AI and machine learning in music composition; developed novel compositional software and methodologies; explored creative cognition, ethics, and AI’s impact on contemporary music practice. Supervisors: Dániel Péter Biró, Örjan Sandred. Results accesible [here](#).

2020-2024 – Researcher, “Sounding Philosophy,” Grieg Academy, University of Bergen.
Interdisciplinary project integrating composition, philosophy, and science; participated in seminars, artistic productions, and publications. Funded by the Norwegian Artistic Research Program. **More information** [here](#).

2017–2019 – Master’s Research: “Music Expert–Novice Differences in Speech Perception”,
University of Victoria. Designed and led a cognitive study (81 participants) examining the effects of musical training on audiovisual speech perception using the McGurk paradigm. **Accessible** [here](#).

2013– Bachelor’s thesis in Music Composition – “Fase 4”, Universidad Nacional de Córdoba (Argentina). Investigation focused on the phases of the creative process of a composer. The result consisted on four compositions for diverse instrumental and vocal forces, presented in concert. **Documentation accessible** [here](#). **Thesis accessible only in physical format** [here](#).

2008 – Final Professorship Project: “Sinfonía de Guerra”, University of Córdoba (Argentina). Analyzed political influences in Shostakovich’s 7th Symphony ‘Leningrad’ and developed a pedagogical framework for undergraduate teaching. **Accessible** [here](#).

Scientific publications

Vassallo, J., Sandred, Ö., Vincenot, J. (2025) NeuralConstraints: Integrating a Neural Generative Model with Constraint–Based Composition. Frontiers in Computer Sciences. Special Dossier: “Embodied Perspectives in Music and AI”. **Available** [here](#).

Vincenot, J., Vassallo, J., Sandred, Ö. (2025) MOZ’lib and PWforMax: Rewiring CAC heritage. Proceedings of the 10th Conference on Technologies for Music Notation and Representation (TENOR). **Manuscript available** [here](#).

Academic publications (in artistic research)

Vassallo, J. (2025) Outward Threads – Intuitive Computers / Rational Composers (doctoral reflection, includes musical analysis, scores, and personal reflections). Research Catalogue. **Available** [here](#). **Dedicated website:** www.outwardthreads.net

Vassallo, J. (2024) Exploring Musical Procedural Rhetoric: Computational Influence on Compositional Frameworks and Methods in the piece “Elevator Pitch”. International Journal of Music Science, Technology and Art. 6, 1–16. **Available** [here](#).

Vassallo, J. S. (2023). Symbolic Musical Resynthesis As An Ekphrastic Compositional Practice Using Computational Methods. Culture Crossroads, 22, 129–147. **Available** [here](#).

Vassallo, J. (2022) Machinic automation in the process of text and music composition: The versificator. Proceedings of The 7th Colloquium on Artistic Research in Performing Arts. **Available** [here](#).

Teaching experience

2020-2025 – The Grieg Academy, University of Bergen, Norway: Individual supervision of bachelor’s students (2020-2025); **MUG 151** Chord-based Piano - Instructor, Fall/Spring 2021-2024; **MUV 281** New Composition Techniques for Performers - Instructor, Fall 2022-Spring 2023; **MUG 112** Musical Analysis/Sonata Form - Instructor, Spring 2022; **MUS 203** Composition Seminar - Instructor, Fall/Spring 2020-2022.

2017-2019 – University of Victoria (Canada): Academic Tutor – Learning Assistance Program (graduate-level one-to-one support), 2019; **Teaching Assistant – School of Music**, 2017–2018: **MUS 180E / 280E / 380E / 480E / 580E** Choir (2018; Adam Con/Elizabeth MacIsaac); **MUS 120 A / B**

History of Western Music: Middle Ages–Classicism (2017; Elisa Poole); **MUS 201 A / B Music Theory: Harmony in the Nineteenth Century** (2018; David Clenman).

2010 – National University of La Rioja (Argentina) — Sessional Instructor: Courses: Repertory for Singers; Complementary Piano I; Preparatory Piano.

2010 – National University of Córdoba (Argentina) — Adjunct Instructor in Composition: Individual supervision of BA students (Head Professor: José Halac).

2008–2017 – Institute of Continuous Teacher Training, IFDC VM (Argentina): Instructor: Piano II: Auxiliary Instructor 2008–2014 (Head Professors: Mónica Avaca/Maximiliano Berteau); Course Responsible 2014–2017.

Guest Lectures

2025 – Symposium “ARTILACS – Artistic Research, Artificial Intelligence and Latent Creative Spaces.” Organized by Lübeck University of Music. Nov. 11.

2025 – Speaker at the MetaCreation Lab at Simon Fraser University (CA). Oct. 21

2023 – Guest speaker at the Dissemination Conference: “Artistic creation through digital tools.” Inter Arts Center. Malmö, Sweden. December 9, 2022. The lecture can be watched [here](#).

2022–2023 – Sounding Philosophy Symposium series, The Grieg Academy, University of Bergen: I) “Dimensions” (Feb 23–25, 2022); II) “The Intellect of Sound” (Jun 23–25, 2022; focus on computer/electronic music); III) “Intuition” (Sep 11, 2023).

International Conferences Contributions (selection by international relevance)

2025 – 10th International Conference on Technologies for Music Notation and Representation (TENOR). Central Conservatory of Beijing (China). October 25–27.

2025 – 50th International Computer Music Conference (ICMC) 2025. Northeastern University. Boston, USA.

2024 – 12th IEEE International Conference on Big Data – 2nd Workshop on AI Music Generation (AIMG 2024). Washington, DC, USA. December 15–18.

2024 – European Platform for Artistic Research in Music (EPARM) 2024, Academy of Music, Ljubljana, Slovenia. March 21–23.

2023 – 14th International Society for Artistic Research (SAR) Conference: “Too Early / Too Late.” Norwegian University of Science and Technology (NTNU), Trondheim, Norway. April 19–21.

2021 – 7th Colloquium in Artistic Research in the Performing Arts (CARPA7): “Elastic Writing in Artistic Research.” UniArts Helsinki. August 26–28.

Peer review experience

The European Journal of Social Science Research (Routledge, Taylor Francis Group).

Frontiers in Computer Sciences – Special issue: Embodied Perspectives in Music and AI.

Paper reviewer for the TENOR conference 2025.

Scholarships / Grants obtained

2026 – DAAD PostdocNet-AI Fellowship DAAD, Germany. Short-term research stay in Germany.

2025 – DAAD PostdocNet-AI Networking Grant DAAD, Germany.

2025 – Bergen Kommune – Grant for the development of professional artistic projects in music.

- 2022-2024-2026 – Morten Eide Pedersen Minnefond (MEP).** Project development grants.
- 2023-2026 – Norsk Komponistforening (NKF).** Grants for the publication of recorded works. grants for seed projects, express concert support, artistic residency at Bibalo House.
- 2021 – Norwegian Artistic Research Program (NARP).** Innovation grant (Project: “Sounding Philosophy,” led by Dániel Biró, role: collaborator).
- 2013 – Organization of Iberoamerican States (OEI).** Full scholarship for an artistic residency at the Movement Research Center. New York, NY (USA).
- 2012 – UNESCO–Aschberg.** Full scholarship for an artistic residency at VCCA (Virginia Center for Creative Arts), USA.

Member of professional music organizations

- 2025 – International Computer Music Association (ICMA)** <https://www.computermusic.org/>
- 2023-2025 – Board member of Avgarde Bergen (Norway)** <https://www.avgarde.no/>
- 2023 (ongoing) – Board member of NyMusikk Bergen (Norway)** <https://nymusikkbergen.no/>
- 2024 – NyMusikk Group of Composers (Norway)** <https://www.nmkomponistgruppe.no/>
- 2024 – NOPA (Norwegian Society of Composers and Writers)** <https://nopa.no/>
- 2021 – NKF (Norwegian Society of Composers)** <https://komponist.no>
- 2021 – TONO (Norwegian collective management company for copyright holders in musical works)** <https://tono.no>

Non-academic job positions

- 2012-2019 – Concert organizer and promoter** in Argentina and internationally, coordinating and touring multiple ensembles across Europe and Latin America, including large-scale international tours and high-profile performances. Examples: European Tour 2016 with La Sanluistango, with concerts in Granada, Valdemossa, Alcala de Henares, Madrid, Zaragoza, Zurich, and other cities; Latin American Tour with La Sanluistango with concerts in Ecuador and Colombia; European Tour 2019 with La Sanluistango with 35 shows across Poland, Italy, Germany, Austria, and Switzerland, including a performance at the Argentinian Embassy in Rome.
- 2025 – Statistician (freelance)** for the company Genius Sports. <https://www.geniussports.com/>
- 2025 – Data annotator (freelance)** for the company INNODATA. <https://innodata.com/>
- 2020 – Music transcriber** for the British Columbia Folklore Society. <https://folklore.bc.ca/>
- 2019 – Campaign assistant** for the United Way University of Victoria campaign 2019. More information: <https://www.uvic.ca/faculty-staff/campus-services/united-way/>

Academic References

Dr. Dániel Péter Biró (former doctoral supervisor)

Professor for Composition at The Grieg Academy, University of Bergen. Tel. +47 905 68 135;
dpbiro@uib.no

Prof. Örjan Sandred (former doctoral co-supervisor)

Professor for Composition, Electronic and Computer Music at the Desautels Faculty of Music, University of Manitoba (Fort Garry Campus). Tel. +1 204 474 9721; Orjan.Sandred@umanitoba.ca

Dr. W. Andrew Schloss (former master's supervisor)

Emeritus Professor for Electronic and Computer Music, Acoustics, and Ethnomusicology. University of Victoria; aschloss@uvic.ca